MIL-T-14091E(ME)
6 June 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-14091D(ME)
23 November 1981

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TRIPOD, SURVEYING: EXTENSION-LEG-TYPE

This specification is approved for use within the USA Belvoir Research, Development and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers an extension-leg-type tripod for surveying instruments.

1.2 Part number. The specification part number for the tripod, surveying: extension-leg-type shall be as follows (see 3.18 and 6.2):

M14091 - X

A = with telescopic plumbing rod.
B = without telescopic plumbing rod.

Specification part number.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: USA Belvoir Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRBE-TSE, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5606 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 6675

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2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-781	- Strapping, Steel, and Seals.
GGG-P-501	- Plumb Bob.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-W-530	- Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors.
MIL-T-704	- Treatment and Painting of Materiel.
MIL-C-46168	- Coating, Aliphatic Polyurethane, Chemical Agent Resistant.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-H28	- Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.
FED-STD-H28/2	- Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services, Section 2, Unified Thread Form and Thread Series for Bolts, Screws, Nuts, Tapped Holes and General Applications.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-889	- Dissimilar Metals.

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the non-Government documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 2016 - Moisture Content of Wood.
D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The tripod shall be the extension-leg-type and shall be equipped with a threaded instrument fastener, triangular shape head, a headcap, a carrying sling, and a case attached to the tripod containing a wrench, plumb bob, cord, cord adjuster and cord centering plumb holding device. When a bayonet-type plumbline holder is provided, an additional standard plumbline holder shall be furnished for arctic use (see figure 1).

3.2 First article. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4 and 6.3). Any changes or deviations of tripods from the approved first article during production will be subject to the approval of the contracting officer. Approval of the first article will not relieve the contractor of his obligation to furnish tripods conforming to this specification.

3.3 Materials. Material shall be as specified herein. Materials not specified shall be selected by the contractor and shall be subject to all provisions of this specification.

3.3.1 Metal parts. All metal components of the tripod shall be nonmagnetic, except for the corrosion resistant steel (CRS) points.

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3.3.2 Webbing. Cotton webbing shall conform to MIL-W-530, type IIa, class 4, color olive drab.

3.3.3 Wood. One of the following species of hardwood shall be used: White ash, European beech, yellow birch, pecan hickory, or hard maple. Slope of grain shall not exceed 1 inch in 15 inches. Moisture content shall be not less than 7 percent or more than 15 percent when determined in accordance with ASTM D 2016.

3.3.4 Material deterioration prevention and control. The tripod and subcomponents shall be fabricated from compatible materials, inherently corrosion resistant or treated to provide protection against the various forms of corrosion and deterioration that may be encountered in any of the applicable operating and storage environments to which the tripod and subcomponents may be exposed.

3.3.5 Dissimilar metals. Dissimilar metals shall not be used in intimate contact with each other unless protected against galvanic corrosion. Dissimilar metals and methods of protection are defined and detailed in MIL-STD-889.

3.3.6 Identification of materials and finishes. The contractor shall identify the specific material, material finish or treatment for use with component and subcomponent, and shall make information available upon request to the contracting officer or designated representative.

3.3.7 Recovered materials. For the purpose of this requirement, recovered materials are those materials which have been collected from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials, as distinguished from virgin raw materials. The components, pieces and parts incorporated in the tripod may be newly fabricated from recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, provided the tripod and subcomponents produced meets all other requirements of this specification. Used, rebuilt or remanufactured components, pieces and parts shall not be incorporated in the tripod and subcomponents.

3.4 Screw threads. All screws and screw threads shall be in accordance with FED-STD-H28.

3.5 Shock. The tripod, extended to its full length, shall not be damaged when tested in accordance with 4.6.2.1.

3.6 Stability. The tripod, set up for operation, shall withstand a superimposed load of not less than 100 pounds without slippage of the joints, abrupt bends of the legs at the joints, or abrupt bending in the joints. There shall be no permanent deformation of the legs, and each leg shall resume its orginial position upon removal of the load. Provisions shall be made to tighten all tripod connections to accommodate shrinkage. The testing of the tripod stability shall be performed in accordance with 4.6.2.2.

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3.7 Tripod head. The tripod head (see figure 1) shall be approximately triangular shaped; each side shall be 6.75 inches long ±0.75 inch. A 2.25 to 2.50-inch diameter hole shall be provided in the tripod head; the center of the hole shall be located at the bisectors of the angles formed by the sides of the tripod head. Bearing blocks shall be provided at each vertex for hinge, pin-type bearings, not less than 0.375 inch long and 0.375 inch in diameter. A single stud bolt and a fiber washer shall be located under the tripod head at each vertex to apply pressure on the bearing blocks for the adjustment of tension on the hinges.

3.7.1 Instrument fastener. An instrument fastener (see figure 1) shall hold the surveying instrument in place on top of the tripod head. The fastener shall be attached to the tripod head by a sliding arrangement. The sliding arrangement shall be pivoted and fastened at one end to the bottom of the tripod head (milled head); allowing the instrument to be positioned anywhere within the perimeter of the hole in the center of the tripod head. Threads on the fastener shall be 0.625-11 UNC-2A conforming to FED-STD-H28 and FED-STD-H28/2. When the instrument fastener is pushed upward to its extremity it shall protrude above the tripod head not less than 0.375 inch and not more than 0.50 inch. When not in use, the instrument fastener shall drop below the surface of the head. Provision shall be made for suspending a plumb bob from the instrument fastener center in such a way that the pivot point of the plumb bob line itself or of the plumb bob line extended by the plumbline device shall be within 0.50 inch, ±0.0625 inch, of the top of the tripod head when fastened to an instrument. The total unobstructed plumbline swing shall be not less than ±5 degrees from the vertical. The plumbline holding device shall be a quick-disconnect type so that the plumb bob can be removed for use of the optical plumb. The grip portion of the instrument fastener shall be long enough to permit the fastening of an instrument by the operator wearing arctic gloves. The grip portion of the plumbline holding device shall be long enough to permit the insertion of the plumbline holding device into the instrument fastener by an operator whether he is or is not wearing arctic gloves.

3.8 Hinges. The hinges shall provide a firm connection between the legs and the tripod head. Pin-type bearings of the hinge not less than 0.375 inch long and not less than 0.375 inch in diameter shall connect the hinge to the bearing blocks of the tripod head.

3.9 Legs. The three tripod legs shall be the extension-leg type, enabling the lower part of the leg to slide into the upper part of the leg. When the leg is extended to its full length, the lower part of the leg shall lap not less than 2.5 inches into the upper part of the leg. The extended length, measured from the center of the hinge to tip of the steel point shall be 70 inches, ±2 inches. The closed length of the leg, measured from the center of the hinge to the tip of the steel point, shall be 44 inches, ±2 inches. A cotton webbing or leather strap with buckle shall be attached to the outside of one leg to hold the three legs together.

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3.9.1 Upper part. The upper part of the tripod leg shall consist of two wooden dowels or two aluminum dowels, a metal spacer, and a metal band with a clamping device for holding the lower part of the leg in place when adjusting the tripod to the required height.

3.9.2 Lower part. The lower part of the tripod leg shall consist of two wooden dowels or two aluminum dowels, or a single oblong section made from aluminum or wood, two metal stops, a metal foot spur, and a metal shoe with a steel point.

3.9.2.1 Metal shoe. The metal shoe shall be 4 to 7 inches long and a thickness and width to form a socket-type arrangement to accommodate the lower section. The lower end shall be seated in the socket of the metal shoe. The lower end of the metal shoe shall be tapered.

3.9.2.2 Steel point. The top cross section of the steel point shall match the bottom cross section of the metal shoe as to dimensions and configuration. The point shall be fastened to the metal shoe except when a replaceable point is supplied, the top of the point may have a hex-shaped cross section of proper dimensions so that the wrench supplied (see 3.13) can be used to tighten or remove the replaceable points. There shall be a taper beginning with the taper on the metal shoe to the tip of the point. The length of the entire taper, including metal shoe and the point shall be 3 to 4 inches. The point shall be CRS and hardened to RC 40-50.

3.9.2.3 Foot spur. There shall be a foot spur on the outside of the metal shoe on each leg and shall extend out from the face of the shoe 1.50 inches $\pm$0.05 inch.

3.9.3 Construction. When wood is used in the construction of the legs, all joints shall be secured with oval-head wood screws countersunk into the metal part of the joint. At joints that require tightening, hex head lag screws or self-locking hex head bolts and nuts may be used. When aluminum dowels are used in the construction of the legs, the joints shall be secured with aluminum rivets, peened to a button head. All joints shall be secured with waterproof cement to prevent penetration of moisture.

3.10 Headcap. The headcap shall be nonmagnetic metal or high-impact plastic. Provision shall be made for fastening the headcap to one of the metal spacers and for holding the headcap flat against the tripod leg. The headcap shall have provisions to be attached to cover the tripod head with the instrument fastener. If high impact plastic is used as the headcap material, a nonmagnetic metal thread insert shall be molded in the headcap to mate with the instrument fastener.

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3.11 Battery box attachment. One of the metal spacers attached to the upper dowels of the tripod leg shall be used as a bracket for holding the battery box to the outside of the tripod leg. The bracket shall be offset 0.375 inch, ±0.0625 inch, from the tripod leg. The upper edge of the bracket shall be notched, 1.375 inches long by 0.125 inch deep, ±0.0625 inch.

3.12 Plumb bob. The plumb bob shall conform to GGG-P-501, type I. The plumb bob shall be furnished with not less than 7.50 feet of braided linen cord, cord adjuster and plumbline holding device; all assembled for operation.

3.13 Wrench. A wrench shall be furnished to permit the adjustment of all bolts and nuts.

3.14 Case. A case made from leather, cotton webbing, or high-impact plastic shall hold the wrench and plumb bob assembly. The case shall be attached to the inside of one of the tripod legs. The case shall not hinder the full movement of any part of the tripod leg.

3.15 Carrying sling. An adjustable, padded carrying sling of cotton webbing shall be fastened to one leg of the tripod. The sling shall be sufficient length for carrying the tripod on the shoulder.

3.16 Telescopic plumbing rod. When specified (see 6.2), a telescopic plumbing rod with a mounted circular level shall be furnished. The plumbing rod shall be nonmagnetic metal. The level shall have a sensitivity of not less than 20 minutes per 2 millimeters. The rod shall be graduated so that the height of the surveying instrument may be determined to the nearest 0.1 inch. The rod shall be attachable to the instrument fastener by a quick-release lock. Provision shall be made for firm attachment of the rod to one leg of the tripod. The rod shall be fabricated so that the inner and outer members shall move over the fully extended length without binding or bending.

3.17 Weight. The weight of the tripod excluding the plumb bob, case, wrench, and carrying sling, shall not exceed 15.5 pounds.

3.18 Identification marking. The tripod shall be identified in accordance with MIL-STD-130, and shall include the military part number (see 1.2). The marking shall also be in the package.

3.19 Treatment and painting. The portions of the tripod normally painted internally or externally shall be cleaned, treated and painted in accordance with MIL-T-704, type F or G, as applicable. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), topcoat color shall be camouflage green 383 conforming to MIL-C-46168. The instrument contact surface of the tripod head and the threaded portion of the instrument fastener shall not be painted.

3.20 Workmanship. All edges shall be rounded or beveled. All joints shall be firm and dowels shall be firmly seated in their sockets. Dowels shall be straight. Metal and wood shall be free from cracks, scratches, or splits.

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Screws and boltholes shall be drilled and shall have burrs removed. Bolts, nuts, screws, and rivets shall be tight. There shall be no binding when shortening or lengthening the tripod legs. The tripod shall not wobble and legs shall not bend when the tripod is extended to its full length. Paint shall be evenly applied on all painted surfaces.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Component and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and material used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards, as applicable.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).
c. Inspection of packaging (see 4.7).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.6.2.

4.4 First article inspection.

4.4.1 Examination. The first article tripod shall be examined visually as specified in 4.6.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection. The examination shall be conducted prior to testing specified in 4.4.2.

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4.4.2 Tests. The first article tripod shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Sampling. Sampling for examination and test shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.2 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.5.1 shall be examined visually for defects as specified in 4.6.1. AQL shall be 0.65 percent defective for major defects and 1.5 percent defective for minor defects. Examination shall take place prior to testing specified in 4.5.3.

4.5.3 Tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.5.1 shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2. AQL shall be 0.65 percent defective.

4.6 Inspection procedure.

4.6.1 Examination. The tripods shall be examined as specified herein for the following defects:

Major

101. Material not as specified.
102. Material deterioration prevention and control not as specified.
103. Dissimilar metals not as specified.
104. Identification of materials and finishes not as specified.
105. Recovered materials not as specified.
106. Screw threads not as specified.
107. Metal parts missing or not as specified.
108. Cotton webbing not as specified.
109. Tripod head not as specified.
110. Instrument fastener not as specified.
111. Hinges not as specified.
112. Plumb bob assembly not as specified.
113. Tripod legs not as specified.
114. Metal shoe not as specified.
115. Steel point not as specified.
116. Foot spur not as specified.
117. Construction not as specified.
118. Headcap not as specified.
119. Battery box attachment not as specified.
120. Telescopic plumbing rod not as specified.
121. Plumbline holding device quick-connect/disconnect not as specified.
122. Wood type or moisture content not as specified.
123. Treatment and painting not as specified.

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Minor

201. Wrench not as specified.
202. Case not as specified.
203. Carrying sling not as specified.
204. Weight not as specified.
205. Identification marking missing, incomplete, or illegible.
206. Workmanship not as specified.

4.6.2 Tests.

4.6.2.1 Shock. The tripod, extended to its full length with protection cap in place, shall be held in a vertical position not less than 16 inches above a flat wood surface, dropped and allowed to fall from the vertical to a horizontal position of the wood surface. This test shall be performed three times, allowing the tripod to fall once on each leg. The presence of broken, cracked, bent, or loose parts shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.2 Stability. The tripod shall be set up in a position for operation on a flat wood or concrete surface and extended to its full height with each leg forming not less than 30-degree angle with the vertical. A stop shall be provided to prevent the bottom end of the legs from splaying out of place. The tripod head shall be level and the clamping device for holding the lower part of the leg in place shall be hand tightened. Not less than a 100-pound load shall then be superimposed on the tripod. Any evidence of slippage, abrupt bends, or abrupt bending at any joint shall constitute failure of this test. In addition, upon removing the load from the tripod, any remaining deflection in the leg indicating permanent deformation shall constitute failure of this test.

4.7 Inspection of packaging.

4.7.1 Quality conformance inspection.

4.7.1.1 Unit of product. For the purpose of inspection, a completed pack prepared for shipment shall be considered a unit of product.

4.7.1.2 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.7.1.3 Examination. Samples selected in accordance with 4.7.1.2 shall be examined visually for the following defects. AQL shall be 1.0 percent defective.

Major

124. Preservation not as specified.
125. Headcap not secured on the tripod head.
126. Plumb bob assembly, plumbline holding device and wrench not contained in the case.
127. Plumbing rod, when furnished, not attached to leg as specified.

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128. Legs not secured together with strap.
129. Wood block not inserted in the end of box as specified.
130. Unit containers not as specified for level A.
131. Shipping containers not as specified for levels A and B.
132. Strapping not as specified.
133. Marking illegible, incorrect, incomplete or missing.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each complete tripod shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method III using a box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c, style optional. The headcap shall be secured in place on the tripod head. The plumb bob and wrench shall be contained in the case. The plumbing rod, when specified (see 3.16), shall be attached to the leg, and the legs shall be secured together with the strap. A fitted wood block shall be inserted in the end of the container to prevent damage to the container from the points. Box closure shall be in accordance with appendix to the box specification method V.

5.1.2 Commercial. Commercial preservation shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, level B, or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The tripods preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-621, class 2, style optional, or PPP-B-601, overseas type, style optional. The maximum gross weight of the box shall not exceed 200 pounds. Strapping shall conform to QQ-S-781, class I, type I or IV, finish B, size as applicable.

5.2.2 Level B. The tripods, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, 11Vc, style optional. The gross weight of the boxes shall not exceed the weight limitation of the box. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Commercial. The tripods, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951. The tripods may be shipped individually or consolidated in containers or on pallets.

5.3 Marking. Marking for level A or B shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Commercial marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951 and each container shall be marked with cube and gross weight.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tripod is intended for use with theodolites, levels, electronic distance measuring devices, and other surveying instruments.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).
c. Specification part number required (see 1.2).
d. When a plumbing rod is required (see 3.16).
e. Color required when other than as specified (see 3.19).
f. Degree of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the items should be an initial production. The first article should consist of one or more units. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, tests, and approval of the first article test results and disposition of the first article.

6.4 Information figure. Figure 1 shows types of fasteners which have been found acceptable; however, the figure is included for illustration only and is not intended to preclude the furnishing of another fastener which conforms to this specification.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Level tripod
Plumb bob equipped
Plumbline holding device
Telescopic plumbing rod
Theodilite tripod
Tripod, extension leg
Tripod, surveying

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodian:
Army - ME

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

Review activities:
Army - AR
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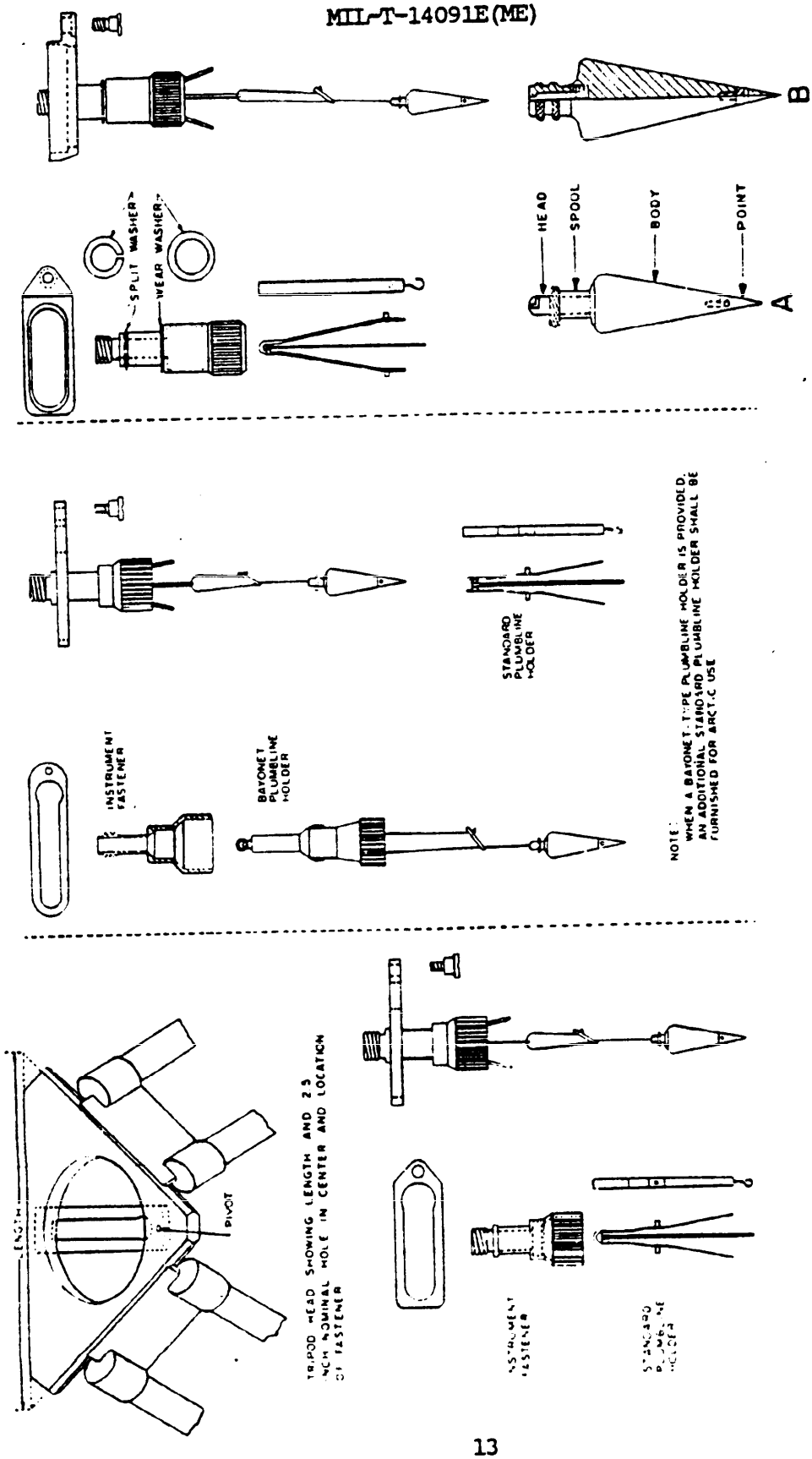


FIGURE 1. Instrument fasteners tripod head, with plumbline holders.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-T-14091E(ME)	Tripod Surveying; Extension-Leg-Type

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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